



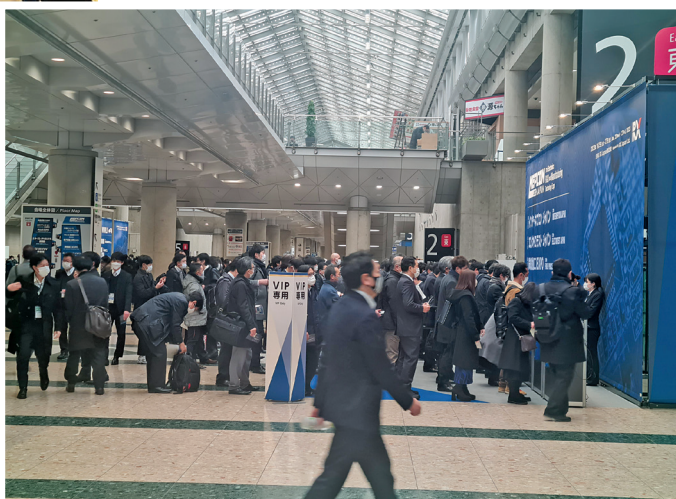
Vertical stacking robots



Packet sorting robots



The TCS booth



Visitors' registration area

Autonomous robots

Whenever the words 'electric vehicles' or 'autonomous vehicles' were uttered, I would imagine these were related to cars, two-wheelers, or trucks. But the co-located shows on Smart Logistics and Smart Factory made me realise that the smart robots managing the warehouses and factories are the real growth market for such tech—at least currently.

Smart robots are the vehicles that are electric, autonomous, and becoming super-smart. They are being developed and deployed in all shapes and sizes. There are 30cm tall robots that sort and place packets with ease. There are bigger ones that pick components from the storehouse and place them in the machines that consume them to manufacture products.

There are also those that go up and down the warehouse storage racks, pick the right container, and bring it down to pass on to another guy (again a robot), who takes it to the right destination. And, then there are the strong ones that can pick the whole rack (filled with inventory) and move the entire rack from one place to another. Phew! Just seeing them all work together was mind-boggling.

I can go on with the wonderful new tech I saw at NEPCON, but these three trends were the ones that stood out. **EFY**

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